GITHERO • LESSON 2 • 8 MINUTES

Check Changes with Git Status

Git Repository Basics

Learning objective

Use git status to understand which files are untracked, modified, or staged.

Core idea

The **git status** command is your project dashboard. It does not change files. It reports the current branch and shows what Git will or will not include in the next commit.

Commands to know

Command / pattern	Purpose
`git status`	Show detailed repository status
`git status --short`	Show a compact status

Step-by-step workflow

- **1.** Create a file named **notes.txt**.
- **2.** Run **git status**; the file appears as untracked.
- **3.** Stage it with **git add notes.txt**.
- **4.** Run **git status** again; it now appears under changes to be committed.

Common mistakes

- Assuming a saved file is automatically included in Git history.
- Committing without checking which changes are staged.
- Confusing untracked files with deleted files.

Practice task

Create two files, stage only one, and run **git status**. Identify which file is staged and which remains untracked.

Quick check

Does git status modify your project or only report its current state?

Tip: Run git status before and after important Git commands so you can observe what changed.